

General Purpose Commands

date

shows the current date with day, month, time and the year

date +%m

month number

date +%h

month name

date +%y

last 2 digits of year

date +%H

hours

date +%M

minutes

date +%S

seconds

echo "message"

print message on screen

cal [month] [year]

show the calendar

bc -l

calculator (press Ctrl + C to exit)

who

show the list of users

whoami

show the login user

clear

clear the terminal screen

man [command]

provide manual for a command

Directory Commands

pwd

shows the current working directory

mkdir [directory name]

create a directory

cd [directory name]

move inside a directory

cd ..

move back to parent directory

ls

list all files and directories

ls -l

list files and directories with details

ls -a

list all hidden files and folders

rmdir [directory name]

delete a directory (only if it is empty)

File Commands

touch [file name]

create an empty file

cat [filename]

display the content of a file

head [filename]

display first 10 lines of a file

tail [filename]

display last 10 lines of a file

cp [source file] [destination file]

copy content of source file to destination file

rm [filename]

remove or delete a file

mv [old file name] [new file name]

rename a file

mv [filename] [path]

move file to a new location

file [filename]

display the type of file

wc -l [filename]

display number of lines

wc -c [filename]

display number of characters

wc -w [filename]

display number of words

File / Directory Permissions

d - directory

r - read

w - write

x - execute

- - - no permission

- rw- r-- r-- - type user group other

chmod symbols

u - user

g - group

o - other

a - all

chmod a+rw file.txt

give read, write, execute permission to all

chmod u-rw file.txt

remove read and write permission from user

Octal Method

0 - no permission

1 - execute

2 - write

3 - write and execute

4 - read

5 - read and execute

6 - read and write

7 - read, write and execute

chmod 777 filename

000 - no permission for user, group and other

777 - full permission to user, group and other

VI Editor (Visual Editor)

vi filename

open file in vi editor

Esc → i

insert mode

Esc → :wq

save and quit

Esc → :q!

quit without saving

Esc → o

insert in next line

Esc → Shift + o

insert in previous line

Esc → Shift + i

insert at start of line

Esc → Shift + a

insert at end of line

x

delete a character

r

replace a character

u

undo

:e!

undo all changes

Ctrl + r

redo

dd

delete one line

15dd

delete 15 lines

p

paste after line

Shift + p

paste before line

Shift + v

select whole line

v

select characters

y

copy

Search

Esc : /word

search from top, press n for next match

Esc : ?word

search from bottom, press n for previous match

Replace

Esc :%s/current/new/g

replace all occurrences in file

Esc :1 s/current/new/g

replace all occurrences in first line

Esc :1 s/current/new/1

replace first occurrence in first line

Esc :2,4 s/current/new/g

replace from line 2 to 4

Esc :2,\$ s/current/new/g

replace from line 2 to end of file

Line Numbers

Esc :set nu - show line numbers

Esc :set nonu - remove line numbers

SED (Stream Editor)

used to modify files without opening them

sed

stream editor command

-n

line specific output

-e

multiple expressions

s

substitute

g

global

d

delete

p

print

Print Operations

sed -n '3p' data

print 3rd line

sed -n '\$p' data

print last line

sed -n '3,5p' data

print 3rd to 5th line

sed -n '/INDIA/p' data

print lines containing INDIA

sed -n -e '2p' -e '4p' data

print 2nd and 4th line

Replace Operations

sed 's/old/new/g' data

replace old with new (display only)

sed -i 's/old/new/g' data

replace old with new in original file

sed '4s/old/new/g' data

replace in 4th line only

sed '2,6s/old/new/g' data

replace from line 2 to 6

sed '\$s/old/new/g' data

replace only in last line

Delete Operations

sed '4d' data

delete 4th line

sed '\$d' data

delete last line

sed '2,6d' data

delete line 2 to 6

sed '1d;3d' data

delete 1st and 3rd line

NANO Editor

sudo apt-get update -y && sudo apt-get install nano -y

install nano editor

nano demo

open file in nano

Ctrl + o

save file

Ctrl + x

exit editor

Ctrl + k

cut line

Ctrl + u

paste line

Alt + u

undo

Alt + e

redo

Ctrl + w

search